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SUPERSEDING
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FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TOWEL, PAPER: (PLASTIC-WIPING)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a soft, highly absorbent, non-abrasive, sanitary paper wiping towel.

1.2 Classification. Wiping towels furnished shall be one type and grade.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced.
PPP-T-97 - Tape, Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7920

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) Standards:

T 245 - Silicates and Silica in Pulp (Wet Ash Method).
T 402 - Standard Conditioning and Testing Atmospheres for Paper, Board, Pulp Handsheets, and Related Products.
T 404 - Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard.
T 410 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T 413 - Ash in Paper.
T 432 - Water Absorption of Bibulous Paper.
T 456 - Wet Tensile Breaking Strength of Paper and Paperboard.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry, One Dunwoody Park, Atlanta, GA 30341).

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Towels shall be soft, highly absorbent tissues made from fibrous cellulosic material, which may include reclaimed fiber.

3.2 Physical properties. The physical properties of the paper towels shall be as specified in table I when tested in accordance with 4.6.

TABLE I. Physical properties of paper towel

Properties	
Basis weight (min) (24 x 36 - 500)	27 pounds
Tensile strength (min)	
Dry	
Machine direction	25 oz/in
Cross direction	12 oz/in
Wet	
Machine direction	5 oz/in
Cross direction	3 oz/in
Ash content (max)	1.5 percent
Percent silica (max)	0.5 percent
Absorptiveness rate (max)	
0.1 ml water	15 seconds
0.1 ml oil	25 seconds
Total absorption (min)	
Water	600 percent
Oil	300 percent

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3.3 Size. The area of each towel shall not be less than 250 square inches with one dimension not less than 14-3/4 inches.

3.4 Construction. The towels shall be 3-ply and folded. The plies shall be securely joined by mechanical means.

3.5 Color. The color of the wiping towels shall be the suppliers option.

3.6 Workmanship. The towels shall be pliable soft, smooth and free from holes, lumps, dirt, and abrasives when rubbed on the clean surface of materials commonly wiped by this type of material such as plastic finishes or acrylic sheets. The towels shall be free of lint and dust.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated. A lot shall consist of all towels offered for inspection at one time.

4.3 Inspection levels. The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed as percent defective shall be as follows:

Sample unit	Inspection level	AQL	Examination para.
Shipping container	S-2	2.5	4.4
Towel	S-4	4.0	4.5

4.4 Examination of preparation for delivery. Packed, marked, and closed cases of towels obtained in accordance with 4.3 shall be examined for compliance with the applicable requirements in section 5. Each unit of the sample size shall be examined for the applicable defects listed in table II.

TABLE II. Defects in preparation for delivery

Examine	Defect
Containers	Not as specified or style ordered.
Contents	Not as specified.
Packaging	Not level specified. Improper method of closure.
Material	Any component missing, damaged, or otherwise defective.
Marking	Omitted or incomplete. Incorrect.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components. Damaged containers.

4.5 Examination of end item. Each towel drawn in accordance with 4.3 shall be examined for the defects and imperfections listed in table III.

TABLE III. Examination of the end item

Examine	Defect
Dimensions	Contains area less than minimum square inches specified.
Construction	Not folded. Not 3-ply.
Workmanship	Dirt spots, slime spots, color spots, scabs, lumps, lint, holes, slivers, shives, wrinkled, or crushed.

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4.6 Testing of the end item. Each lot of towels shall be tested for the characteristics in table IV. The sample unit shall be 25 wiping towels randomly drawn from at least 10 shipping containers. The average value for each characteristic shall meet the requirements specified in table I.

TABLE IV. Instructions for testing end item

Characteristics	Specification requirement paragraph	Test method	Requirement applicable to	Results reported to nearest
Atmospheric conditions		T 402	All testing	
Basis weight	Table I	T 410	Lot average	0.1 pound
Absorption rate	Table I	T 432	Lot average	second
	Table I	& 4.8	Lot average	
Total absorption	Table I	4.7	Lot average	1 percent
Tensile strength:				
Dry	Table I	T 404	Lot average	0.1 oz/in
Wet	Table I	T 456	Lot average	0.1 oz/in
Ash	Table I	T 413	Lot average	0.1 percent
Percent silica	Table I	T 245	Lot average	0.1 percent

4.7 Total absorption.

4.7.1 Water. Condition the specimens in accordance with TAPPI T 402. Weigh each specimen of size 4 x 4 (+ 1/8) inch, immerse them in distilled water at 25°C for 3 minutes (+ 10 seconds). Remove the specimens by lifting them at one corner until their surfaces are vertical to the floor, and allow the excess water to drain off for 60 + 10 seconds. Place each in a tared weighing bottle and reweigh. Calculate the percent absorption as follows:

$$\text{Percent absorption} = \frac{\text{Wet weight} - \text{Dry weight}}{\text{Dry weight}} \times 100$$

4.7.2 Oil. Follow the procedures in 4.7.1 using oil as specified in 4.7 in lieu of water. Drain time for the immersed sample should be 20 + 2 minutes.

4.8 Absorption rate (oil). Test in accordance with TAPPI T 432 using 0.1 ml of white mineral oil, 80-90 S.U. (Saybolt Universal) viscosity, +30 Saybolt color, N.F. grade in lieu of water.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A or B. Seventy-two folded towels shall be packaged in a dispensing type box in accordance with standard commercial practice. When specified in the contract or order, the dispensing box shall be constructed so that removal of one sheet automatically removes a portion of the next sheet (see 6.2).

5.1.2 Level C. The towels shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment, from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twenty packages of towels shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. Each box shall be closed and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

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5.2.2 Level B. Twenty packages of towels shall be packed in a box conforming to PPP-B-636 Class domestic, grade 200. Each box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. Towels shall be packed to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable.

5.3 Marking. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123 or MIL-STD-129, as applicable.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Paper wiping towels are suitable for use in cleaning, wiping, and polishing soft, delicate surfaces such as plastic finishes or acrylic plastic sheets.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Applicable level of packaging (see 5.1).

PREPARING ACTIVITY: GSA - FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 30 cents each.

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5. Otherwise specified, the specification to the extent specified herein. Unless